Getting started with NextBook

A first-week guide for a new business: enter your items, customers and suppliers, then your opening balances, so you can start working on real transactions.

You don't need to know accounting to follow it. Every step says what to click and what to check afterwards.

---

1. The big picture

NextBook keeps stock, sales, purchases, cash and accounting in one place. You enter each fact once and the other parts of the system use it.

Setting up takes four stages, in this order:

Stage	What you do	Why it comes here
A. Check the basics	Company, currencies, warehouse	Everything else depends on them
B. Build your lists	Items, customers, suppliers	You can't record a balance for something that doesn't exist yet
C. Enter opening balances	What you already own and owe on day one	Without them your reports start from zero
D. Check and go live	Compare with your own books, add staff	Catches mistakes while they are cheap to fix

Pick a start date and keep to it. Choose a day, such as the first of the month or the first day of the year. Every opening balance should be what you had at the end of the day before. Then enter every real transaction from that day on.

What the system already did for you

When your company was created, NextBook prepared these, so you don't have to:

- A **chart of accounts** (cash, bank, receivables, payables, inventory, sales income, and so on)
- **Currencies**, with your base currency marked
- **Units of measure** (piece, kilogram, litre, carton, and others), item **categories** and **brands**
- A **Cash customer**, for walk-in sales with no named customer
- **Expense categories**
- An open **financial period** for the current year
- A **main branch** with a **warehouse**
- Your login, with full (super admin) access

Review these lists and add to them. You don't need to start from scratch.

---

2. Stage A: check the basics

2.1 Company

Open **Administration → Company** (or the company page from the header).

Check:

- **Calendar type**, Gregorian or Jalali. All dates in the system follow it.
- **Base currency**, the currency your reports are shown in.
- **Business type**, which decides which fields appear on the item form. A pharmacy sees batch and expiry. A mobile or computer shop sees variants and serial numbers.
- **Legal details**: name, address, phone and tax number. They are printed on your invoices.

> **Decide the calendar and base currency now.** Changing them after real transactions exist is difficult and risky.

2.2 Currencies and rates

Open **Administration → Currency**.

- Your base currency has a rate of 1.
- If you trade in other currencies (USD, PKR and so on), open **Currency Rate Updates** and enter today's rate for each one.
- The other currencies start with **no rate**. You can't enter an opening balance in a foreign currency until its rate is set, because the system needs it to convert to your base currency.

2.3 Warehouse

Open **Administration → Warehouse**.

- Your branch already has a main warehouse. Rename it if you like.
- Add more if your stock is in several places, for example "Shop" and "Godown".
- Every stock quantity you enter belongs to a specific warehouse.

---

3. Stage B: build your lists

3.1 Items

Prepare the groupings first (optional, 5 minutes)

Under **Administration**, look at **Category**, **Brand** and **Unit Measure**. Add anything missing, such as a category called "Building materials" or a unit called "Sack". Picking from these lists later is quicker than typing.

If you sell the same product to different kinds of customers at different prices, also create **Customer Groups** (for example "Wholesale" and "Retail").

Option 1: many items at once with Fast Entry (recommended for a first load)

Open **Inventory → Fast Entry**.

1. You get a table of empty rows. Fill in one item per row: **name** and **unit of measure** are required. Category, brand, purchase price and sale price are optional.
2. Items get codes automatically.
3. Empty rows are ignored. Add more rows when you need them.
4. Click save.

If you already know the opening quantity, you can fill in the **quantity, warehouse and cost** on the same row. That enters the opening stock at the same time (see 4.2). To keep things simple, you can leave them blank and use Fast Opening in Stage C.

Option 2: one item at a time

Open **Inventory → Item → New**. The form asks for:

Field	Notes
Name and **Code**	The code is suggested for you. Both must be unique.
Item type	*Stockable* (you count it) or *service* (freight, installation: no stock).
Unit of measure	The unit you count it in. Can't be changed after the first transaction.
Category	Optional but useful for reports.
Asset, income and cost accounts	Filled in for you. Leave them unless your accountant says otherwise.
Variants	Every item has at least one. This is where the **sale price, purchase price, barcode and minimum stock** are set. If the item comes in sizes or colours, add one row per combination.
Batch / expiry tracking	Only for goods with a lot number or expiry date (medicine, food).

Batch tracking is permanent. Once a transaction has been posted for the item, you can't turn it off. Only switch it on for goods that really have lots or expiry dates.

Tips

- If you have a barcode scanner, put the barcode on the variant. You can print labels from **Inventory → Barcode Print**.
- Don't worry about getting every field perfect. You can edit an item later. A few fields (unit of measure, item type, batch tracking) lock once the item has posted transactions.
- If you have hundreds of items, start with your top sellers. Add the rest as you meet them. The item picker on every invoice also lets you create a new item on the spot.

3.2 Customers

Open **Ledger → Customer → New**.

Field	Notes
Name	Required. Everything else is optional. The name — and the phone and email, if you fill them — must not belong to another customer. A supplier may share them.
Code	Optional. Left empty, the system gives the next number. It must be unique, and it cannot be changed once the customer is saved.

Field	Notes
Phone, WhatsApp, email, address, contact person	Appear on the customer statement.
Province / country	For reports and filters.
Currency	The currency you normally trade in with this customer.
Customer group	Ties the customer to group pricing and discounts.
Payment term	The payment window you give them (cash, 7 days, 30 days). The receivable aging report uses it.
Credit limit	Switch it on and set the amount you are willing to let this customer owe.
Discount	A standing percentage discount.
Photo and attachments	Optional, for example a copy of a contract.
Opening balance	What this customer owes you today. See 4.3.

Use **Create** to save, or **Create & New** to save and start the next customer.

- You already have a **Cash customer**. Use it for walk-in sales so you don't have to name every buyer.
- A customer with no transactions and a zero balance can be deleted. Otherwise the system refuses; set the customer inactive instead.
- On the customer's page, three buttons — **Active**, **Inactive**, **Blocked** — set the status. Only an active customer is offered when you create a sale, receipt or payment.

3.3 Suppliers

Open **Ledger → Supplier → New**. The form is the same as the customer form, and the **Opening balance** there is what **you owe** the supplier.

3.4 Someone who is both a customer and a supplier

Create them once as a customer and once as a supplier, and keep the two accounts separate. When you want to cancel what each owes the other, use **Cash Transactions → Set-off**. It cancels the two balances against each other without any cash moving. The same name, phone and email may be used on both accounts, because they are only checked against accounts of the same type.

---

4. Stage C: enter opening balances

An *opening balance* is what you already owned or owed on your start date. There are four kinds, and each one has its own place. Don't put them all into one journal entry.

What you are entering	Where	What the system does
Money in cash boxes and bank accounts	Chart of Account	Debits the account
Stock in the warehouse	Inventory → Fast Opening (or the item form)	Debits Inventory Stock

What you are entering	Where	What the system does
Customers who owe you	The **Opening balance** section of each customer	Debits Accounts Receivable, and the customer's statement starts with this amount
Suppliers you owe	The **Opening balance** section of each supplier	Credits Accounts Payable, and the supplier's statement starts with this amount

In every case the other side of the entry goes to a system account called **Opening Balance Equity**. After all the openings are in, this account shows the difference between what you own and what you owe, which is your starting capital. Your accountant can move it to the proper capital accounts later.

4.1 Cash and bank

Open **Account → Chart of Account**.

1. Your cash accounts already exist: *Cash in Hand, Cash in Safe, Cash in Bank, Petty Cash*. Open each one.
2. If you have several real bank accounts, create one account per bank account. Choose the type **Cash or Bank**, and name it clearly, for example "Azizi Bank – AFN".
3. In the **Opening** section, choose the **currency** (and rate, if it isn't your base currency), the **side** (debit for money you hold) and the **amount**.
4. Save.

Delete or deactivate the accounts you don't use, so cashiers aren't confused by them later.

4.2 Stock

Open **Inventory → Fast Opening**.

1. The table lists every item that has no opening yet.
2. For each item you hold, fill in:
    - **Warehouse**
    - **Quantity**
    - **Cost**, the price you paid per unit. This sets the value of your stock.
    - **Batch and expiry date**, only for batch-tracked items
3. Rows with a quantity of zero are skipped.
4. Save.

Don't leave the cost empty. The quantity is recorded, but no value is posted to accounting, so your stock value will look too low.

Once only. An item that already has an opening disappears from this list, so the same stock can't be entered twice. After you start trading, never use it to fix quantities. Use a **Stock Adjustment** (you'll count and correct) or a purchase.

Don't enter your opening stock as a purchase. A purchase would also create a payable to a supplier, and you'd owe money you don't owe.

4.3 Customer balances

For each customer who owes you money:

1. Open **Ledger → Customer**, open the customer, and click **Edit**.
2. In **Opening balance**, find the currency row and enter the **amount**, and the **rate** if it isn't your base currency. Add a short remark such as "Balance carried from old ledger".
3. Save.

If a customer owes you in two currencies, fill in two rows. Rows left empty are ignored, and each currency can be used only once per customer.

The amount is what they owe you.

4.4 Supplier balances

Same as 4.3, on **Ledger → Supplier**. The amount is what you owe the supplier.

4.5 Everything else

Fixed assets (vehicles, shop fittings), loans and owner's capital have no screen of their own. Your accountant should record them with a single **Account → Journal Entry** dated on your start date.

> If you're not sure whether an item belongs in an opening journal entry, ask. Stock, customer and supplier balances must **not** go in the journal entry, because they would be counted twice.

---

5. Stage D: check your numbers

Before the first real sale, spend 15 minutes comparing the system with your own records.

Open **Reports** and check these:

Report	What to look for
Trial balance	Total debit equals total credit. It always should.
Stock / inventory reports	Every item has the quantity you counted, and the total stock value matches your estimate.
Receivable aging	The list of customers who owe you matches your old customer ledger. The total matches the opening balances you entered.
Payable aging	The same, for suppliers.
Balance sheet (as of your start date)	Cash, receivables and stock on the asset side. Payables on the liability side. The difference is in equity.

If something is wrong:

- **A customer or supplier balance:** edit the opening balance on that record. It is simply replaced.
- **A stock quantity:** open the item and correct its opening, as long as no stock has been issued from it. Once stock has moved, use a **Stock Adjustment**.
- **A cash or bank account:** edit the account's opening.

Once real transactions begin, stop editing openings. Every later correction should be a visible document (journal entry, stock adjustment or reversal), so the history stays clean.

---

6. Add your staff

Open **User Management**.

1. **Roles**: create a role for each kind of job. For example, *Cashier* (sales and receipts), *Storekeeper* (items and stock), *Accountant* (everything financial).
2. **Users**: add each person, attach them to a role and to their branch.

Give each person the smallest role that covers their work. Keep the **super admin** role for one or two trusted people. Menus and buttons that a role doesn't allow are hidden, so a missing menu usually means that person has no access to it.

---

7. Your first real day

Now you can trade.

I want to…	Go to
Sell something	**Sale → New**
Record money from a customer	**Cash Transactions → Receipt**
Buy goods	**Purchase → New**
Pay a supplier	**Cash Transactions → Payment**
Record rent, electricity, etc.	**Expense → Expense**
Move cash between boxes and banks	**Account → Account Transfers**
Move stock between warehouses	**Inventory → Item Transfer**
Correct a stock count	**Inventory → Stock Adjustment**

The one rule to learn: Draft, Post, Reverse

Almost every document works the same way.

1. **Draft:** you've saved it, but nothing has changed in stock or accounting yet. You can still edit or delete it.
2. **Post:** the document takes effect. Stock moves, balances change and the document is locked.
3. **Reverse:** to undo a posted document, you reverse it. It stays in the history, and a mirror document cancels it out. Then you enter the correct one.

There is no "edit a posted invoice" button, by design. It keeps your books trustworthy, and it's what an auditor or the tax office expects.

Handy things to know

- **Search box** (top of every page): type a customer, item or document number to jump straight

to it.
- **Branch switcher** (header): if you work in more than one branch, make sure you're in the right one before you enter anything.
- **Language switcher**: English, Dari and Pashto.
- **Trash** (**System → Trash**): deleted records can be recovered from here.
- **Activity logs**: show who did what and when.
- **User Manual** (profile menu): a detailed guide to every module, inside the app.

---

8. Setup checklist

Tick these off as you go.

Basics

- ☐ Calendar type and base currency confirmed
- ☐ Legal details and logo entered (they print on invoices)
- ☐ Exchange rates entered for every currency you use
- ☐ Warehouse(s) named correctly

Lists

- ☐ Categories, brands and units checked
- ☐ Items entered (Fast Entry or item form)
- ☐ Prices set on each item's variant
- ☐ Customers entered
- ☐ Suppliers entered

Opening balances (as of your start date)

- ☐ Cash and bank accounts
- ☐ Stock, with cost
- ☐ Customer balances
- ☐ Supplier balances
- ☐ Other assets and loans (journal entry from your accountant)

Check

- ☐ Trial balance is balanced
- ☐ Stock list matches your count
- ☐ Receivable and payable totals match your old ledger

Go live

- ☐ Roles and users created
- ☐ Invoice print format checked with a test sale (delete or reverse it afterwards)
- ☐ First real sale posted

---

9. Common questions

I made a mistake in an opening balance. Can I fix it? Yes, until you start trading. Edit the customer, supplier or account, and the opening is replaced. For stock, open the item and fix its opening. The system locks an opening once stock has been issued from it. After you start trading,

use stock adjustments and journal entries instead.

I started selling before entering my opening stock. Fast Opening is meant for the very beginning, and a stock opening is dated the day you enter it. Talk to your accountant before adding opening stock to a business that has already traded, so the dates and the cost are handled correctly.

Why can't I see a menu my colleague sees? Your role doesn't include it. Ask an administrator to adjust your role under **User Management → Roles**.

What is "Opening Balance Equity"? The balancing side of every opening entry. When you've entered all your openings, its balance is your starting capital. Your accountant will normally move it to your capital accounts.

What should I do if the system says a record "is in use"? Something has already been posted against it, such as an item that was sold or a customer with invoices. Edit what you can, or deactivate it instead of deleting it.